

CAN GERMANY TAKE THE HOME ADVANTAGE?

Germany will be keen to put behind its recent tournament disappointments and give Toni Kroos **the perfect goodbye** by winning Euro 2024 at home.

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With one of the most renowned legacies in international football, Germany will enter Euro 2024 aiming to overcome its recent record of early exits from major tournaments and lift the trophy on home soil for a record fourth time.

After experiencing success during Joachim Löw's 15-year reign — including the resounding 2014 FIFA World Cup win — Germany crashed out of the 2018 World Cup at the first hurdle, and in the round of 16 during Euro 2020.

Hansi Flick, who replaced Low in 2021, failed to lead his side past the group stage of the 2022 World Cup

Strong contender: Amidst a wealth of talent, Thomas Müller and Toni Kroos remain the key players for host Germany. GETTY IMAGES

and was promptly replaced by Julian Nagelsmann, who began his tenure with losses in friendlies against Turkey and Austria.

However, the return of midfield maestro Toni Kroos from retirement, combined with the emergence of young players from the Bundesliga, will aid Nagelsmann's task. Wins over heavyweights France and the Netherlands in friendlies have further renewed German fans'



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